Egg Drop Soup

Serves 3–4 (as a starter)

Ingredients

- Chicken Stock – 4 cups (about 1 liter, organic or homemade preferred!)
- Sesame Oil – 1/2 teaspoon
- Salt – 3/4 teaspoon
- Sugar – 1/8 teaspoon
- White Pepper – 1/8 teaspoon
- Turmeric – 1/2 teaspoon (or 5 drops yellow food coloring, optional, for color)
- Cornstarch – 3 tablespoons (mixed with 1/3 cup water)
- Eggs – 3, lightly beaten
- Scallion – 1, chopped
- MSG – ¼ teaspoon (increase to personal preference)

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Instructions

1. **Season the Broth**
   Bring the chicken stock to a simmer in a medium soup pot. Stir in the sesame oil, salt, sugar, white pepper, and MSG (if using). Add the turmeric or yellow food coloring, if desired. Taste the soup and adjust the seasoning if needed.

2. **Thicken the Soup**
   Mix the cornstarch and water well (it settles quickly). Stir the soup continuously as you slowly drizzle in the slurry to avoid clumps. Let it simmer for a minute or two, then check the consistency; add more starch for a thicker soup or a splash of water for a thinner one.

3. **Add the Egg**
   Stir the soup in a circular motion with a ladle. Slowly drizzle in the lightly beaten egg, continuing to stir. The speed of your stirring will determine the size of the egg flowers—stir faster for fine ribbons, slower for larger clouds.

4. **Serve**
   Ladle the soup into bowls, top with the chopped scallion, and serve immediately.